

donkey kicks to work out my triceps. It is really nice to be lifting again despite the slightly cumbersome weight set. The hardest part is trying to change out the weights on the bar. The weight set is not too wide so whenever you remove a sprocket from one side, the other side wants to tip over. It's nearly impossible to do without a second person.

I also got to talk to you earlier today—at \$2 per minute it seems like quite the bargain, especially when I consider the alternative, no conversation at all. I am glad to hear that everything is going well, and hearing your voice reminded me of how much I miss being home. Mason sounds like he is growing up so quickly and it breaks my heart that I have to be away from him in this time of rapid change. I want to see his funny face and listen to his temper tantrum as I hand his punk-ass right over to you!

I'm sorry that our neighbor, whatever her name is, is so unreliable. She seemed really nice at first. I guess it's not too hard to sound good, even if you don't back up all the talk. I can't believe that she would simply skip out on babysitting after promising to be there. Hey, not to mention the mail she said she would pick up when you went home—how about that one, huh?

Oh well, from what I hear they should be gone soon. Too bad, I thought that Robin was a nice guy. He helped me a lot, moving that daggone T.V. into the house in the middle of an ice storm.

Well, Jen, the weather forecast in Baghdad shows highs well over 100 degrees for the next week. Thank goodness, I've gotten used to the heat. If it were suddenly 60 degrees here, I think that I would freeze my ass right off. Dust and haze will continue as well. No big surprise there. And, finally, tomorrow "Thunderbolts" are expected to strike in the Al-Ameeria region of Baghdad making it difficult to sell illegal weapons on the street.

I miss you and love both you and Mason very much. When the hell are we coming home anyway?

Love,

A handwritten signature in cursive script, appearing to read "Christian".

Christian